

NSAIDs (Non-Steroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs)

What are NSAIDs?

NSAIDs (pronounced "en-seds") are common pain-relieving and anti-inflammatory medications. Aspirin was the first NSAID — Native Americans used willow bark, a natural source, for pain relief. Human NSAIDs include ibuprofen and celecoxib (Celebrex). There are **NSAIDs made specifically for dogs** that manage pain safely and effectively, with no risk of addiction.

Never give human NSAIDs (ibuprofen, naproxen, aspirin) to your pet unless directed — they can be toxic, especially to cats.

Possible side effects

NSAIDs are generally safe, but can sometimes cause:

- **Stomach and intestinal upset or ulcers**
- **Kidney problems**
- Less commonly, liver or bone marrow problems

Give with food, and we may recommend periodic blood tests for long-term use.

Stop the NSAID and call your veterinarian if your pet has

- Decreased appetite or vomiting
- **Dark, black or bloody diarrhea**
- Increased drinking or urination
- Lethargy, or **yellow gums, skin or eyes** (jaundice)
- Bruising or bleeding under the skin

Never combine

Do not give two NSAIDs together, and never give an NSAID with a steroid. Together they can cause dangerous stomach and intestinal bleeding. If switching between them, ask us how long to wait.

Common steroids	Common NSAIDs
Prednisone	Aspirin
Prednisolone	Carprofen (Rimadyl)
Dexamethasone	Etodolac (EtoGesic)
Methylprednisolone (Medrol)	Deracoxib (Deramaxx)
Triamcinolone	Meloxicam (Metacam)
Cortisone	Firocoxib (Previcox)
Budesonide	Grapiprant (Galliprant), Robenacoxib (Onsior)